

COMBAT AND POLICE SHOTGUNS

Shotguns have a long history as combat weapons, giving service in conflicts from the American Revolutionary War (1775–83) to World War I and beyond. Their cartridges are packed with shot—small lead pellets. The shotgun has always been an effective close-quarters weapon. US infantrymen recognized the value of the six-shot pump-action Winchester 1897 in trench warfare in World War I. Shotguns continued to evolve, with progress centering on increasing the capacity of the magazine and on new types of ammunition for both military and civilian security operations.

